

Inigo Jones

Inigo Jones was one of the greatest English architects of his era. After returning from travels in France and Italy (1613–14), he developed his own unique style from a blend of ancient, Renaissance and Palladian architecture. His plain, dignified designs for the Queen's House at Greenwich (1635) were based to some extent on the Medici villa at Poggio a Caiano, near Florence, but detailed in a style closer to Palladio or Vincenzo Scamozzi (1552–1616). The Queen's House, the severely classical Banqueting House in Whitehall (1619–22) and the Queen's Chapel at St James's Palace (1623) were radically different from the picturesque Jacobean style of the day. With their focus on symmetry and harmony, directly inspired by Palladio's *Four Books of Architecture*, Jones's designs sparked a revolution in English architecture. He was also in charge of the regulation of new buildings in London; his Covent Garden (1630), an open space surrounded by arcaded houses and a church (opposite, dubbed 'the handsomest barn in England'), effectively introduced formal town planning to the capital.

